

ALISON SCHULTZ

I am a financial economist interested in how financial and tax systems benefit or harm society. I work on the real effects of financial markets, financial crime, corporate taxation, and tax abuse.

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EDUCATION

- 2017 - 2023 Graduate School of Social and Economic Sciences, University of Mannheim, Germany
PhD Finance, Summa cum laude
Thesis title: From Trade to Terror – How Global Banks Impact Local Economies
Supervisor: Prof. Ernst Maug, Ph.D.
- 2014 – 2017 University of Kassel, Germany
M.A. Global Political Economy, 1.0 (A)
- 2012 – 2014 University of Mannheim, Germany
B.Sc. Economics, Minor: Political Science, 1.5 (A)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Since 2022 **Tax Justice Network**, Research Fellow
Research and advocacy with a focus on:
- Corporate tax avoidance: For the Tax Justice Network's *State of Tax Justice* report, I quantified global revenue losses resulting from discrepancies between reported profits and actual economic activity in the OECD's aggregated country-by-country reporting data and assessed the revenue potential of public country-by-country reporting.
 - Unitary taxation: Co-leading the Tax Justice Network's engagement with EU policymakers on *Business in Europe: Framework for Income Taxation (BEFIT)*, I synthesized academic insights on the optimal design of unitary taxation and conducted revenue estimates for various *BEFIT* proposals.
 - Global Anti-Base Erosion Model Rules (Pillar Two) with a specific emphasis on the EU Corporate Minimum Tax: I analyzed the interaction between the EU corporate minimum tax and various *BEFIT* proposals.
 - Net wealth taxes: I condensed the academic evidence on net wealth taxes for policymakers and civil society and provided country-level revenue estimates for various specifications of a net wealth tax.
 - Administrative cooperations: Working with tax authorities from the Global South, I co-organized two workshops on the use of administrative tax data and scoped potential joint projects, including with the tax administration in Panama.
 - Money laundering and terrorist financing: As part of the EU Horizon 2020 project *TRACE*, I analyzed money laundering risks linked to weak regulation of real estate and high-value assets in EU Member States.
- Since 2020 **Finance Watch Germany**, Contractor for Data Analytics
Research with a focus on:
- The regulatory attempts to curb Greenwashing: I analyzed how green funds responded to transparency regulations — including the ESMA Guidelines on the use of sustainability-related terms in fund names and the overhaul of the SFDR — using Morningstar and Lipper fund-portfolio and fund-characteristics data.

- Greenwashing in the European mutual fund industry: I analyzed the holdings of over 400 funds marketed as “green” within the EU concerning their investments in fossil fuel companies.
 - Anti-competitive impacts of large asset managers: I crafted and negotiated Finanzwende’s position paper on the anti-competitive impacts of large asset managers.
- 2017 to 2022 **University of Mannheim, Chair of Corporate Finance**, Researcher
- I undertook different research projects on the real impacts of financial markets, stability, and crime (further details provided below).
 - I taught corporate finance (M.A. in Business Administration), academic writing (B.A. in Business Education), and data analysis using Stata (M.A. in Business Administration).
 - I oversaw the chair budget and managed collaborations between the finance area and corporate partners.
- 2/2020 to 8/2020 **Deutsche Bundesbank Frankfurt**, Guest researcher
- I investigated problematic interbank lending patterns observed in the German credit register.
 - I contributed to the central bank's economic impact assessment of Covid19-related measures.
- 2015 to 2017 **International Center for Development and Decent Work (ICDD), University of Kassel**, Research and teaching assistant
- I researched the potential for German foreign policy to support co-determination rights along the supply chains of German companies, and presented the study at the Transnational Labor Dialogue in Berlin (2016).
 - I taught several courses (details below).

ACADEMIC RESEARCH

Broken Relationships: De-Risking by Correspondent Banks and International Trade. Joint work with L. Borchert , R. De Haas, and K. Kirschenmann. Accepted for publication in the **Review of Financial Studies**.

We study how terminated correspondent banking relationships affect international trade. Drawing on firm-level export data from emerging Europe, we show that when local banks lose access to correspondent services, their corporate clients (especially small- and medium-sized enterprises) experience significant export declines. Firms only partially offset lost exports with higher domestic sales, resulting in lower total revenues and employment. Other firms cease operations entirely. These firm-level impacts aggregate to lower product-level exports from countries more exposed to correspondent bank retrenchment.

Guns and Kidneys: How Transplant Tourism Finances Global Conflict. Revise and Resubmit at the **Journal of the European Economic Association (JEEA)**. Awarded with the **Young Economist Award of the European Economic Association (EEA)**.

This paper investigates the impact of organ trafficking on local conflict using georeferenced data on conflict events and hand-collected data on local transplant infrastructure in countries known for illegal transplanting. Exploiting exogenous variation in kidney demand from the US waiting list for kidneys, I find that higher US kidney demand increases conflict in localities with a transplanting hospital. A one-standard deviation increase in the US waiting list for kidneys raises conflict probability by 17% and the number of conflict events by 0.9%. This effect is stronger for higher-income waiting list patients, who are more likely to afford the costs of an illegal transplant, while it is absent for dialysis patients, with limited travel ability. Furthermore, armed groups with transplanting capacities intensify attacks when US kidney demand is higher, spreading violence spatially.

Banks of a Feather: The Informational Advantages of Being Alike. Joint work with P. Bednarek, V. Dinger, and N. von Westernhagen. Published in the **Journal of Money Credit, and Banking**.

Banks lend more to banks that are similar to them. Using data from the German credit register and proprietary supervisory data on the quality of banks' loan portfolio, we show that a similar portfolio of the lending and borrowing bank helps to overcome information asymmetries in interbank markets. While interbank lenders generally do not adjust their lending to information on the counterparty's portfolio quality, banks with an exposure to similar industries and regions strongly react to this private information. Lending between similar banks is particularly important for borrowers with an opaque loan portfolio, which do not obtain credit from dissimilar peers.

Which Money to Follow? Evaluating Country-Specific Vulnerabilities to Illicit Financial Flows. Joint work with V. Grondona, M. Meinzer, N. Moncam, and G. Villanueva. Published in the **European Journal on Criminal Policy and Research**.

This study presents a new, multidisciplinary method to assess countries' vulnerabilities to illicit financial flows (IFFs) in different economic channels. Acknowledging that money laundering involves legitimate financial channels and regulatory gaps, our approach combines quantitative data on bilateral economic activities with a qualitative assessment of the regulatory frameworks of trade and investment partners. Using publicly available and contemporary data along with a legal analysis focused on the loopholes that can be exploited for IFFs, the proposed methodology addresses the limitations of current National Risk Assessments (NRAs) and offers an accessible and cost-effective approach that can be applied for anti-money laundering.

Profit Shifting via Carbon Emission Trading. Presented at the World Inequality Conference 2026, at the International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF) Annual Meeting 2024 and the Verein für Socialpolitik (VfS) Annual Meeting 2024.

This study presents preliminary evidence that the European Emission Trading Scheme (EU ETS) is used by multinational groups to shift profits from high- to low-tax EU countries by mispricing intra-group allowance transfers, in using internal forward contracts. Combining the EU Transaction Log with Orbis ownership data and hand-collected disclosures from the financial statements of the largest carbon-trading hubs, I show that allowance trading within corporate groups departs markedly from what non-tax motives would predict. Trading between firms under a common owner is pervasive, and most internal volume is reciprocal, concentrated at the calendar year-end despite the April surrender deadline, and most pronounced among firms that never surrender allowances, for which a compliance motive is absent. These flows are routed through trading hubs in low-tax jurisdictions. Their timing, lumpiness, and insensitivity to the day's market price, together with hub disclosures of related-party derivative trading valued with internal models, are consistent with the use of internal forward contracts whose off-market pricing channels gains to the low-tax hub.

POLICY-ORIENTED RESEARCH

EU-Wide Unitary Taxation: A Path to a Fair Corporate Tax System. Joint work with Miroslav Palanský. Presentation scheduled at the International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF) Annual Meeting 2024.

Taxing Extreme Wealth: What Countries Around the World Could Gain from Progressive Wealth Taxes. Presented at the Paris School of Economics 2023.

Tax the Rich: From Slogan to Reality. Report for the Green faction of the European Parliament. Joint work with D. Coll Sol and M. Palanský. Media Coverage: [Le Monde](#), [Tax Notes](#)

The State of Tax Justice 2023. Contribution as part of the Tax Justice Network team. Media Coverage: [CNN](#), [DW](#), [BBC](#)

Study supporting the evaluation of administrative cooperation and combating fraud in the field of value-added tax. 2023. Study commissioned by DG TAXUD, European Commission. Joint work with ECORYS.

Greenwashing in Zeiten von Ukrainekrieg und Energiekrise. 2022. Joint work with M. Senn. Media

coverage: [*Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung*](#), [*taz*](#), [*Handelsblatt*](#), [*Focus*](#)
[*Greenwashing im großen Stil. Wie "nachhaltige" Fonds die Klimakrise befeuern*](#). 2021. Joint work with M. Senn. Media coverage: [*Deutschlandfunk*](#), [*Süddeutsche Zeitung*](#), [*Börsen-Zeitung*](#)
[*Instruments of German Foreign Economic Policy for Promoting Co-Determination along Supply Chains*](#). Report commissioned by the Hans Böckler Stiftung and presented at the Transnational Labor Dialogue in 2016, published in **Scherrer, Christoph (2017): Enforcement Instruments for Social Human Rights along Supply Chains**, Labor and Globalization 9, pp. 50-154.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2019 to 2022	Stata in Finance , University of Mannheim, Instructor.
2019 to 2021	Corporate Finance I: Capital Structure, Cost of Capital and Valuation , University of Mannheim, Teaching Assistant.
2020 to 2022	Corporate Finance II: Mergers, Acquisitions and Divestitures , University of Mannheim, Teaching Assistant.
2019 to 2022	Master's, Bachelor's and Seminar Theses , University of Mannheim, Supervisor.
2019 to 2022	Introduction to Academic Writing , University of Mannheim, Instructor.
2016	International Economics for non-economists , University of Kassel, Instructor.
2015	Governance of the World Market: Institutions, Instruments and Experiences , University of Kassel, Teaching Assistant.

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2022	Young Economist Award , European Economic Association
2019 - 2022	Ph.D. Scholarship , Stiftung Geld und Währung
2017 - 2018	Graduate School Scholarship , German Excellence Initiative

VOLUNTARY WORK

2020 - present	SustainVBL , Initiator of the campaign for a sustainable investment of public pensions
2019 – present	Bürgerbewegung Finanzwende Berlin , Data Analyst
2011 – present	»GLOBE – Global Learning at vocational schools« , Trainer and coordination of the school-trainer network including the planning of about 50 workshops around Germany per year.
2015 – 2017	German for Refugees, University of Kassel , Teacher
2012 – 2014	Student Initiative Club of Rome University of Mannheim
2009 – 2010	Hogar de niños Alalay, Santa Cruz, Bolivia , Voluntary Service

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Computing	Stata (proficient), R (proficient), Python (proficient), Matlab (intermediate)
Languages	German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), French (basic), Dutch (basic)